



PARLIAMENTARY DEBATES

OFFICIAL REPORT

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BOUND VOLUMES of the Official Report (each with a comprehensive Index) are issued periodically during the Session. There is no fixed subscription rate, but prices will be quoted on each publication.

*Published by Office of Chamber Reporting,
Parliament House, Accra.*

*Designed and Printed by Publishing Department,
Parliament House, Accra.*

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THE
PARLIAMENT OF THE REPUBLIC
OF GHANA

FIRST MEETING, 2026

Wednesday, 11th March, 2026

*The House met at the Chamber,
Parliament House, at 1:54 p.m.*

[HON FIRST DEPUTY SPEAKER,
MR BERNARD AHIAFOR, IN THE
CHAIR]

[PRAYERS]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, let us proceed to the item numbered 5 to take the correction of *Votes and Proceedings* as well as the *Official Report*.

**VOTES AND PROCEEDINGS AND
THE OFFICIAL REPORT**

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Let us start with the *Votes and Proceedings* of Tuesday, 10th March, 2026.

Page 1...9. Yes, Mr Frank Afriyie?

Mr Frank Afriyie: Mr Speaker, on the page numbered 9, the item numbered 7, I think I have a slight problem with the heading. I would like to read;

“WRIT OF ELECTIONS FOR
PARLIAMENTARY BY-ELECTIONS
OF AYAWASO EAST CONSTITUENCY”

I think the word “BY-ELECTIONS” should rather be written as “BY-

ELECTION”. Mr Speaker, are you with me?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, are you talking about the marginal notes?

Mr Afriyie: Yes.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Table, take note

Page 10—Yes?

Mr Afriyie: The item numbered 11, the item labelled “a”, the fourth line, the words there should be written as “Standing Order” instead of “Standings Orders” as written in the document.

Then again, on the last but one line, the word “Commodities” in the sentence, “Government Outstanding Claims and Commodities...” should be replaced with the word “Commitments.”

Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Mr Frank Afriyie, do you have a copy of your Standing Orders?

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Mr Afriyie: Mr Speaker, with respect, I do.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: What does it say? Is it Standing Order or Standing Orders?

Mr Afriyie: Mr Speaker, the word over here is “Standings Orders”. So, the word “Standing” should, in my estimation—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, your correction should be to delete the letter “s” at the end of the word “Standings” and not the letter “s” at the end of the word “Orders”

Mr Afriyie: Absolutely, that was the correction I made.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So Table, take note.

Page 11...12

Hon Members, the *Votes and Proceedings* of Tuesday, 10th March, 2026, as corrected is hereby adopted as the true record of proceedings.

Hon Members, I have two *Official Reports*, that of 3rd March, 2026 and 27th February, 2026. Let us first correct the *Official Report* of 27th February, 2026. Hon Members, any corrections?

[No correction was made to the Official Report of Friday, 27th February, 2026]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Now, the *Official Report* of 3rd March, 2026 is for your correction. Hon Members, any corrections?

[No correction was made to the Official Report of Tuesday, 3rd March, 2026]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, indulge me to acknowledge the presence of students from Serwaa Nyarko Girls Senior High School led by Daniel Sekyere, Head of Government

Department. They are from the Manhyia South Constituency and are 63 in number.

[Students of Serwaa Nyarko Senior High School were acknowledged.]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: We also have students from Dominican University led by Cecilia Gyamfi Amoakooa, the Tour Operator and Guide. They are from the United States of America (USA). They are 17 in number.

[Students of Dominican University were acknowledged.]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: We also have Abokobi Presbyterian Basic School, led by Armah Mary Owusu, a teacher. They are from the Dome-Kwabanya Constituency. They are 72 in number.

[Pupils of Abokobi Presbyterian Basic School were acknowledged.]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: We have Cedar Crest International School, led by Raphael Nkrumah, the Vice-Principal. They are from the Assin South Constituency and are 80 in number.

[Pupils of Cedar Crest International School were acknowledged.]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: We also have Konkonuru Methodist Basic School, led by Kumi Felicia, Head Teacher. They are from the Akuapim South Constituency and are 70 in number.

[Pupils of Konkonuru Methodist Basic School were acknowledged.]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, on your behalf, I welcome our dear students to the Parliament of the Republic of Ghana and urge them to have a fruitful visit. Kindly resume your seats.

Yes, Majority Leader?

Mr Mahama Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I think we can take Questions. The Minister for Roads and Highways is here.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. Yes, Hon Member?

Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, there should be no objection to that. But just to draw the attention of the Leader to the fact that, I see a number of Motions. A while ago, the Leader showed deep regrets to referrals that have been given to Committees and have not been worked on. On the flip side, we have referrals that have been worked on, programmed and been on the Order Paper for a while.

2:04 p.m.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: I have no objection with starting Questions today, but can the Leader apprise the House on what the plan is for today? Of course I am aware the Leaders will conclude today, but what is going to happen to these Motions that have been advertised on the Order Paper for years?

Hon Collins Dauda is here and the Report for the House Committee is ready

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Chief Whip, the application is really not an application. We have a chronology of Business. Now we have taken the item numbered five. All the Majority Leader is seeking to do is that we proceed in that order by taking the item numbered six.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I am not objecting. I am supporting him, but I am also reminding him that those Businesses have been on the Order Paper for a while. So, if he has not thought about taking an action on them, he should also be considering it. But I am not objecting to us taking Questions. I am not.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. Hon Members, the Hon Minister for Roads and Highways is scheduled to respond to some Questions. He is dutifully in the House. May I humbly ask him to take the designated seat? While I call on Hon Kwame Anyimadu-Antwi to ask the Question numbered 587.

Mr Kwaku Asante-Boateng: Mr Speaker, Hon Anyimadu Antwi is not available and he has asked that I ask the Question on his behalf.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: How did he ask you to ask the Question?

Mr Asante-Boateng: He has given me the authority to.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. Please do.

ORAL ANSWERS TO QUESTIONS

MINISTRY OF ROADS AND HIGHWAYS

Completion of Roads in Odumase

Mr Kwaku Asante-Boateng *on behalf of Mr Kwame Anyimadu-Antwi (NPP — Asante Akim Central):* Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when Odumase Town Roads will be completed.

Minister for Roads and Highways (Mr Kwame Govers Agbodza): Odumase is a fast-growing peri-urban town along the main Accra–Kumasi Highway (N6).

Current Programme

The Odumase Town Roads was awarded under the contract titled “Rehabilitation of Odumase Town Roads (7.79km)”. The project commenced on 9th December, 2024 for completion by 8th June, 2026. The progress of works is at 15 per cent physical completion. Works have stalled due to delay in payment for work done. Efforts are being made to get the contractor back to site to complete the outstanding works.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, any supplementary questions?

Mr Asante-Boateng: Mr Speaker, yes. Hon Minister, we are not looking at

the effort, but all things being equal, what the people of Asante Akim Central are interested in is the completion of the roads. In your own capacity as the Minister for Roads and Highways, what are you doing to get the work completed? Are we going to terminate and re-award? We want to see some concrete steps that you want to take. If you can outline that to the House, we would be grateful.

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker, my Colleague asked a very important question. There are steps that need to be taken before one can legitimately terminate a contract.

Mr Speaker, if a project starts on 9th December at a project sum of GH¢73 million and only 15 per cent is done and work stops, that does not suggest to me that there is enough capacity. For his information, this project also did not have a commitment authorisation before starting the work. Perhaps, the contractor knowing that he did not get commitment authorisation is afraid that if he works, he will not be paid. But as I said in the past, this President is different. He did not, as a policy, ask any contractor to stop work. So, anybody who knows that contractor should tell him to go back to site and work because what he has done so far is absolutely not much to stop work. When it comes to payment, he just raised a certificate of GH¢5 million and then because that was not paid — Let us not forget that there were people whose certificates dated back to 2016 who were still not paid. So, if your certificate came in 2025 and you are not paid, you cannot classify yourself as one of those people whose payments are delayed.

Mr Speaker, on record, last year, this President has paid over GHC9 billion towards arrears owed to contractors that he inherited and as long as this House continues to support the Government in terms of budgetary approvals, we will continue to pay the outstanding debt owed contractors so that they can complete outstanding works.

Mr Speaker, thank you.

Mr Asante-Boateng: Mr Speaker, I just want to do another follow-up. We realised that when town roads are being constructed, there are a lot of inconveniences to the inhabitants. So, when trenches are dug and not completed, some have their U-drains in places, others do not have anything and it will interest us to know that there has been a lot of traffic —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, I am just drawing your attention to Order 88(7). You can look at it.

Mr Asante-Boateng: Mr Speaker, kindly indulge me. So, the people usually dodge traffic and use part of their access road within Odumase to join at the back —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, you cannot use a supplementary question to make a Statement, you are violating Order 88(7) (a).

Mr Asante-Boateng: What I am asking is that when is the Hon Minister going to do the needful such that the

roads will be completed? We are interested in the completion of the roads.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: That was the question asked.

Mr Asante-Boateng: But the urgency of it was not embedded in the follow-up question that I asked.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: The Minister has answered that.

Mr Asante-Boateng: What I am saying is that I am just elaborating on the urgency so that he does something about it.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Once the Question is asked and answered, it is overruled.

Mr Asante-Boateng: Mr Speaker, I just want to plead with the Minister to do the needful by currently terminating and re-awarding. We will be interested in that.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, I would take that to be a suggestion but not a question for the Minister to answer.

Mr Asante-Boateng: It is not a question. I am just suggesting to the Minister to do that in order to expedite action on the completion.

Thank you very much.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, this being a constituency-specific Question, we then take the

Question numbered 615, standing in the name of Mr Alhassan Umar, Member of Parliament for Zabzugu.

Mr Alhassan Umar (NDC — Zabzugu): Mr Speaker, thank you. With your leave, I want to abandon the Question.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. Question accordingly withdrawn and struck out as such.

[Question withdrawn by leave of Mr Speaker.]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: The Question numbered 585, standing in the name of Bright Asamoah Brefo, Member of Parliament for Bibiani – Anhwiaso-Bekwai.

Upgrading of Praga Roads in Bibiani

Mr Bright Asamoah Brefo (NDC — Bibiani-Anhwiaso-Bekwai): I beg to ask the Minister for Roads and Highways the plans the Ministry has for the upgrading of Praga Roads in Bibiani.

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker,

Background

Bibiani is the capital of the Bibiani/Anhwiaso/Bekwai Municipal Assembly in the Western North Region.

Current Programme

Praga roads have been captured under the contract titled “Rehabilitation of

Selected Roads in Bibiani (1.98km), Western North”. The contract commenced on 6th February, 2025 completion by 5th August 2026. The project is at 13 per cent physical completion. The contractor is on site working.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any supplementary?

Mr Brefo: Mr Speaker, no. I just want to thank the Minister and make sure that —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, this is also a constituency-specific Question.

2:14 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, let us move to the Question numbered 599, which stands in the name of Alhaji Alhassan Mumuni, Member of Parliament for Salaga North.

Plans to construct roads in Salaga North

Alhaji Alhassan Mumuni (NDC — Salaga North): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Roads and Highways the plans of the Ministry to construct the following roads: (i) Bunjai – Lantinkpa – Kidenyi Road (ii) Gindaturu – Chanayili – Epuneyirema Road.

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker,

(i) Bunjai – Lantinkpa – Kidenyi road*[Published by order of Mr Speaker]***Background**

The Bunjai – Lantinkpa - Kidenyi road is an interdistrict road connecting the North East Gonja district of the Savannah Region and the Nanumba North Municipality of the Northern Region. It is a 30km partially engineered gravel road in poor surface condition.

Current Programme

There is no programme on the road.

Future Programme

Engineering design studies will be carried out on the road for consideration upon the availability of funds.

(ii) Gindaturu – Chanayili – Epuneyirema road**Background**

The Gindaturu – Chanayili - Epuneyirema road is an access road in the North East Gonja district of the Savannah Region. It is a 15km partially engineered gravel road in poor surface condition.

Current Programme

There is no programme on the road.

Future Programme

Engineering design studies will be carried out on the road for consideration upon the availability of funds.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: We will then move to the Question numbered 664, which stands in the name of Hon Stanley Yaw Nandaya, Member of Parliament for Wulensi.

Construction of Roads in Wulensi

Mr Stanley Yaw Nandaya (IND — Wulensi): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when the Egambo to Nankpal road as well as the following roads: (i) Magido (ii) Chando (iii) Nnaldo (iv) Njeregando that lead to Lungni will be constructed.

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker,

(iii) Egambo - Nakpal road**Background**

The Egambo - Nakpal road is captured on DFR database as Nakpali-Woribogu-Egambo Feeder Road (24.6km). It is located in the Zabzugu district of the Northern Region. It is an engineered gravel road in poor surface condition.

Current Programme

There is no programme on the road.

Future Programme

Engineering design studies have been carried out on the road for consideration upon the availability of funds.

(i) Lungni- Magido road**Background**

The road forms part of the Lungni-Gmalpedo feeder road in the Nanumba South district of the Northern Region. It traverses Lungni through Magido and Njeregando to Gmalpedo. It is a 15km partially engineered gravel road in poor surface condition.

Current Programme

There is no programme on the road.

Future Programme

Engineering design studies will be carried out on the road for consideration upon the availability of funds.

(ii) Lungni-Chando Road**Background**

The road forms part of the Lungni-Takorade feeder road in the Nanumba South district of the Northern Region. It traverses from Lungni through Chando and Nnaldo to Takorade. It is an engineered gravel road in poor surface condition.

Current Programme

There is no programme on the road.

Future Programme

Engineering design studies will be carried out on the road for consideration upon the availability of funds.

(iii) Lungni-Nnaldo road**Background**

The road forms part of the Lungni-Takorade feeder road in the Nanumba South district of the Northern Region. It traverses Lungni through Chando and Nnaldo to Takorade. It is an engineered gravel road in poor surface condition.

Current Programme

There is no programme on the road.

Future Programme

Engineering design studies will be carried out on the road for consideration upon the availability of funds.

(iv) Lungni-Njeregando road**Background**

The road forms part of the Lungni-Gmalpedo feeder road in the Nanumba South district of the Northern Region. It traverses Lungni through Magido and Njeregando to Gmalpedo. It is a 15km partially engineered gravel road in poor surface condition.

Current Programme

There is no programme on the road.

Future Programme

Engineering design studies will be carried out on the road for consideration upon the availability of funds.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, any supplementary questions?

Mr Nandaya: Mr Speaker, yes.

I would like to find out from the Minister if there could be any interventions on those roads, even though there are no activities scheduled for them. I believe that they could do something about those roads. Whenever it rains, those communities—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, you are violating Order 88(7).

Mr Nandaya: Thank you, I am guided.

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker, I appreciate the point my Colleague is making on the nature of the road. We regularly carry out routine maintenance on roads such as these. We are about to roll out our 2026 routine maintenance activities, beginning in May. I would assure my Colleague that we will do something about it during the routine maintenance activities.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any other supplementary question?

Mr Nandaya: No, Mr Speaker. Thank you very much.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, we have exhausted all the Questions scheduled for the Minister for

Roads and Highways. Therefore, Question Time has ended.

On your behalf, I thank the Hon Minister for Roads and Highways very much for attending upon the House to respond to all the Questions scheduled for him. Hon Minister, once again, thank you. You are hereby discharged.

Yes, Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, the Committee on Independent Constitutional Bodies reports are ready, so if we can lay the *Papers*.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. Hon Members, at the commencement of Public Business, the item numbered 8—Presentation of Papers.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, we can take it.

PAPERS

By the Chairperson of the Committee—

Report of the Committee on Independent Constitutional Bodies on the Annual Budget Performance Report of the Commission on Human Rights and Administrative Justice (CHRAJ) for the year, 2024.

Report of the Committee on Independent Constitutional Bodies on the Audit Committee Report of the Commission on Human Rights and Administrative Justice (CHRAJ) for the year 2024.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Majority Leader? Are we taking the item numbered (b)?

Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, that is so. The indication is that we can lay it.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. The item numbered 8(b) by the Chairperson of the Committee.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, the Chairperson has just stepped out. I want to seek your leave to lay it on his behalf.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, the application is to lay 8(b), the Report of the Finance Committee.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: We have no objection to it.

By Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor on behalf of the Chairperson—

Report of the Finance Committee on the Value for Money Office Bill, 2026.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, do we take the item numbered 9, the Motion?

2:25 p.m.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, before we take the item numbered 9, our small prayer is that in the interim, we take the item numbered 17.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Are we sitting on Mondays?

Mr Dafeamekpor: No, but Mr Speaker, the agreement is that on Wednesdays, if the time permits, we can take a couple of Statements.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, he does not find favour with us. He is picking and choosing. A while ago, we were led by the Majority Leader and we had to lay the Reports of the items numbered 8(a) and (b) but he jumped the item numbered 8(a) (i) and (ii) and continued with the item numbered 8(b). Then we have the item numbered 10 and I had earlier drawn the attention of the Majority Leader to the fact that the item numbered 10 is getting dusty on the *Order Paper*. Then we also have your Report. *[Interruption]*

Mr Speaker, why are they picking and choosing? I do not have a problem with taking the Statement, but the Committee chaired by your good self, the House Committee, is important. *[Interruption]* No, Mr Speaker, I object. That Report must be laid. Let us take the Motion. Then we have a Report from Mr Collins Dauda which is also ready. So, when are we going to take it? *[Pause]*

Mr Speaker, there are other Motions that are equally important. For instance, the item numbered 46 is still outstanding and I know Hon Collins Dauda's Report is also ready.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, can we take the Motion numbered 9 as proposed?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, if I can conclude. With respect, I am just drawing the attention of the Majority Frontbench to page 36.

Hon Rockson-Nelson Dafeamekpor should turn the *Order Paper* to page 36. Do they want us to compromise so they do not take their Report? That is fine. We will compromise. But on page 36, we have a Business there which is the item numbered 46. *[Interruption]* No, I am suggesting to him so that we can navigate properly and then have some agreement.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, I have heard my Brother and his lamentations, but the agreement is that we would take one Statement from Hon Member Ayo Ntebe, then the Leaders will conclude. We will come back to the Motion numbered 9 so that the Leaders will conclude.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Can he repeat that? I did not get that. What are the Businesses he is scheduling? He should propose them properly for the record.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, my proposal is that we take the item numbered 7(c), then we take the item numbered 9 for the Leaders to wind up on the Message on the State of the Nation. Then, depending on the mood of the House, we can look at other Businesses.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I can assure my Colleague that today, the mood of the House is good. So he should include the item numbered 46; we have to take it.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, what is the sense of the House? Do we go to Statements or —

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, we go to Statements. It is just one Statement.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Do we go by the *Order Paper*?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, that is so. The item numbered 7 (c) on the *Order Paper*.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the item numbered 7(c), Statement by Hon Ntebe Ayo William, Member of Parliament for Tatale-Sanguli.

You have the floor.

STATEMENT

Poor Demarcation of Electoral Boundaries and Overcrowded Polling Stations as Root Cause of Election Disputes

Mr Ntebe Ayo William (NDC — Tatale-Sanguli): Thank you, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity, as I make this Statement with great concern to draw the attention of this august House to a matter of great importance that continues to undermine the integrity of Ghana's democratic process, particularly, the poor demarcations of the electoral boundaries and the persistent issues of overcrowding polling stations across this country.

Statement

Mr Speaker, the right to vote is the cornerstone of our democracy, but the conditions under which Ghanaians exercise this right are becoming increasingly problematic.

In several constituencies, including my own, Tatale-Sanguli, the demarcations of electoral areas have not kept pace with the population growth and immigration pattern. As a result, we now see polling stations with voter population far beyond the Electoral Commission's prescribed limits, creating logistical bottlenecks, long queues, delays and in some cases, voter disenfranchisement.

Mr Speaker, this overcrowding is not just a matter of inconvenience, it breeds suspicion, frustration and sometimes chaos, which are precursors to electoral disputes. When citizens are forced to wait for hours under the sun, only to be told voting has ended or materials are inadequate, tensions rise. When results from the overburdened polling stations are delayed or questioned, mistrust festers. This situation becomes a fertile ground for allegations of rigging, voter suppression and general mistrust in the electoral process.

Furthermore, the current demarcations of electoral boundaries often fail to reflect the true socio-political and democratic realities on the ground. Many communities feel misrepresented or completely neglected because boundary lines are drawn without sufficient consultation and review. This leads to disputes not just during the election, but in the broader context of governance and development.

Mr Speaker, I call on the Electoral Commission to take urgent steps as part of the reform processes to review and update the demarcations of electoral areas and constituencies to reflect population changes, settlement patterns and emerging communities. The Commission should also, as well, increase the number of polling stations and voting centers, particularly in densely populated areas, to reduce congestion and enhance the efficiency of voting.

2:34 p.m.

Though the current threshold of voters for the Polling Station is a little below 700, it should be better managed if it could further be brought down to 400 of the Polling Station. In addition, Mr Speaker, the Commission should engage in broader stakeholder consultations with community leaders, civil society, political parties, before finalising demarcation changes. The Commission should also strengthen the voters' education and awareness to ensure all citizens are well aware of where and how to vote ahead of time.

Mr Speaker, we cannot allow poor planning and outdated boundaries to jeopardise the peace and credibility of our elections. Electoral reforms must not only focus on technology and transparency, but also on the practical reality facing the voters at the grassroots.

Ensuring fair representation and smooth electoral processes is not a privilege, it is a democratic necessity, and we must scale up the modality to

Statement

accommodate all citizens, no matter where they live in the country.

Mr Speaker, thank you for this opportunity.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, that is the Statement ably made. It is time for comments. How many comments are we taking from each Side?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, we will just take one-each.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Minority Leader? Very well.

Mr Stanley Yaw Nandaya (IND — Wulensi): Mr Speaker, thank you for this opportunity. I want to comment on the Statement ably made by the Hon Member from Tatale-Sangule. It is a concern in this country, especially in the Northern Region, where settlements are widely spread. We see that some communities, populated communities, would rather be moving to some smaller communities during voting. This is actually discouraging them, especially from having the high turnout when there are elections. If we look at Wulensi, for instance, we have a community called Gmalpedo. It is a larger community with thousands of people, but they rather convey their people to other settlements to vote, and this is actually discouraging them. I believe that if we can really structure the electoral areas, especially where we vote, it will encourage people to participate in voting.

Mr Speaker, I will not talk much, but I support this very Statement that it should be considered and worked on.

Thank you very much for this.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Majority Leadership?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, I will yield to the Hon Member for Berekum West.

Mr Dickson Kyere-Duah (NDC — Berekum West): Thank you, Leader, for yielding to me. I rise to be associated with this very important Statement because my Constituency, Berekum West, is facing a similar challenge. We have a situation where three distinctive towns, for instance, Amomaso, Nanasuano, Benkasa, all these three are boxed into one electoral area, making the work of the Assembly Member very difficult. We also have Tobaabi and Abisasi, two distinct towns bulk to form one electoral area, making work difficult.

So, Mr Speaker, it is important that electoral areas and polling station areas are demarcated in such a manner that you have manageable numbers for proper decentralisation, for proper engagement with electoral areas, and for proper engagement with polling station areas. It is important we look at the current demarcation where one electoral area will cover about 20 kilometres square. I think these things should be looked at and worked on. Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, we have come to the end of comment on that Statement.

Yes, Majority Chief Whip, do you have any indication?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, the indication is that we will take item number 9, so our Leaders can conclude.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Minority Leader, that is the indication. *[Pause]*

Well, at Conclave, let me announce that Leaders are speaking for 30 minutes, half an hour. So, Minority Leader, you have the floor.

MOTION

Message on the State of the Nation, 2026

[Continuation of Debate from 10th March, 2026]

Minority Leader (Osahen Alexander Kwamena Afenyo-Markin): Mr Speaker, this afternoon, I conclude on behalf of the Minority our views on the true state of the Nation. H. E. the President came to the Chamber on 27th February, 2026, and said certain things that demand answers. But, as I proceed, let me remind this House of the veritable words of Thomas Jefferson in his first inaugural address as a third President of the United States of America on 4th March, 1801. Mr Speaker, this is what he had to say:

*“All, too, will bear in mind this sacred principle, that though the will of the **majority** is in all cases to prevail, that will to be rightful must be **reasonable**; that the **minority** possess their equal rights, which equal law must protect, and to violate would be oppression.”*

Mr Speaker, on the strength of these veritable words, I, on behalf of the Caucus I lead, anchor the submissions of our Caucus and to ask the very difficult questions for and on behalf of the Ghanaian people.

So, let me ask these simple questions. How can Governments say it has no money to continue building hospitals, yet suddenly find money to purchase a private jet for the President? Mr Speaker, what are the priorities of this Government? No money for hospitals, but money for jets. No money for the sick, but money for comfort in the sky. No money for the cocoa farmer, yet money to buy jets. No money to subsidise electricity, yet money to buy jets.

2:44 p.m.

No money to fight *galamsey*, yet money to sponsor social events. Mr Speaker, when the Government cannot finish hospitals but can buy aircrafts, it has made its priorities very clear. Again, this nation does not need propaganda. What it needs is a truthful diagnosis and a workable plan.

But before I say a word about the President's speech, let me first refer us to

Article 67 of the 1992 Constitution. It provides that;

“The President shall, at the beginning of each session of Parliament and before a dissolution of Parliament, deliver to Parliament a message on the state of the nation.”.

Mr Speaker, the operating word, “shall”, not “may”, not “should”, “shall”. So, Mr Speaker, on 27th February, what the President did amounted to nothing. He did not fulfil the constitutional command. What he did, Mr Speaker, was that he delivered a performance on the state of his imagination. He did not come to account; he came to impress. He brought us a screenplay. I am not here to applaud his state craft, I am here to expose the flaws in his address and to let Ghanaians know the true state of our nation.

Two hours of soaring rhetoric, elegant metaphors, and carefully managed statistics. What the President forgot was that there were idle hands on the streets of our cities. Over 1,539 workers cleared by Government-owned committee, but they have failed to employ them. This was not mentioned, not even in person. The sacking of the Chief Justice, Justice Araba Esaaba Torkornoo, was not mentioned. Electricity tariff hikes were not mentioned. The *dumsor* that has come back to our homes and our factories was not mentioned. The *Dumsor* levy, GHC1 per litre, was not mentioned.

Mr Speaker, let the record be clear that what happened on 27th February was not

accountability; it was theatre. Today, this Side of the House rises to do what the President refused to do; to speak the truth about the real state of our nation. Two hours of oratory, but the President found no word useful other than — he kept saying “inherited”. He wielded it like a weapon.

Every crisis, “inherited”, every deficit, “inherited”, every debt, “inherited”. But every recovery, he claimed he delivered, every upgrade, he called it achievement. And he attributed every improvement, perhaps, to the courtesy of the miracle workers at Jubilee House.

We submit that this is not governance, but propaganda. Inherited is not a licence; it has become a broken record, and the Ghanaian people are weary of dancing to that worn out tune. Judge this Government not by what they claim they meant, but by what they have done. Not by the excuses they manufacture, but by the lives they have failed to transform.

They claim that they came to meet debts. But what they forgot is that the previous government went to extraordinary lengths to ensure that the country was safe, the economy could run, and public sector workers were paid. The economic recovery that the President referred to and celebrated was as a result of prudent economic management that came before him. Those decisions were necessary. They were the decisions that the very people now taking the bow, spent years attacking, mocking, and weaponising on campaign platforms across this country.

When Ghana's economy buckled under the weight of post-COVID-19 pressures and accumulated structural weakness, it was the New Patriotic Party (NPP) that made the hardest call in recent Ghanaian history. We went to the International Monetary Fund (IMF). We negotiated extended credit facility, we structured the debts and we imposed fiscal discipline at enormous political costs.

The NPP told Ghanaians the truth about their country's finances even when that truth was brutal and even when we knew our opponent would use it against us. Indeed, they used it against us. The very people who now stand in this Chamber taking bows for a recovering economy are the same people who stood on platforms and told Ghanaians that the IMF programme was a betrayer.

They mocked our fiscal consolidation, described our revenue reforms, derided our revenue reforms, weaponised our sacrifice to win elections, and now they have the sheer audacity to stand here and claim the harvest of seeds they never planted, through rain they never endured, on soil they never tended. Mr Speaker, that is not governance; that is opportunism dressed in a borrowed robe.

The same applies to gold. The gold for oil reserve programme that this administration is marketing to Ghanaians as a signature innovation was never invented by this Government. It was conceived, designed, and launched by the NPP Administration, spearheaded

by the former Vice President, Dr Mahamudu Bawumia. Mr Speaker, it was our policy, our framework, our initiative.

What this administration has done is to take that programme, rebrand it, put their name on the door, and present it to the world as though they thought of it themselves. We hereby submit that it is time the Government gave to Dr Bawumia what belongs to Dr Bawumia. There is nothing wrong with continuing a good policy. What is wrong, what is dishonest, and what this Minority will not allow to pass without challenge, is claiming the intellectual and policy credits for a programme the National Democratic Congress (NDC) spent years opposing, and which NPP built from the ground up. Ghana cannot learn right lessons from its recent economic history if those in power are permitted to rewrite it. This Minority will not allow that rewriting to stand.

Mr Speaker, the NDC has betrayed the Ghanaian farmer. When they were in opposition, they promised that they will pay a farm gate price per bag of cocoa, GHC6,000. Today, the reality is different. When farmers woke up one day, the Minister for Finance at the Ministry of Finance, through a press conference, announced a haircut, reduced the price per bag to GHC2,587. This is very disappointing. The farmer who believed in the promises of NDC was disappointed. What did the president say? We should tighten our belts. Meanwhile, Mr Speaker, the President is busily ordering for a new aircraft.

It is not only the cocoa farmer who is suffering.

[The Hon Minority Leader showed a small bag of rice]

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: The rice farmer, who has invested heavily in rice production, is also suffering. Mr Speaker, rice farmers cannot get market for their produce. Mr Speaker, the rice farmers are suffering because many people —

[Members of the Minority lifted cocoa pods, tubers of yam and bags of rice while chanting.]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Minority Leader, your microphone is off. You have the floor.

2.54 p.m.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, people are now depending on cheap imported rice. Our farmers, who invested heavily in rice production, are not getting market for their produce.

Those who have cultivated yams are also suffering. They are not getting access to the market. Nobody is supporting them, and this Government is only depending on gold. They are only interested in Gold Board, promoting *galamsey*.

Mr Speaker, we cannot abandon our farmers and think that by promoting illegal mining and getting cheap gold, we will be developing our economy. This Government is under the illusion that

there are gains in what it is doing. This Government is bound to fail. Mr Speaker, if illegal mining can be stopped, then the Government must show seriousness. It is a public health emergency, and it is a generational crime against children not yet born.

Mr Speaker, the President gave us some numbers that there are some 1,634 blue water guards deployed, 114 case files opened, and 1,033 pieces of equipment tracked. The Minority will not waste time dismissing these figures. The water is still brown; they should know the land is still scarred. The rivers are still dying. We note the reported seizure of approximately 1,000 chanfang excavators at Tema Port.

Mr Speaker, we welcome this; however, it raises questions that scream for answers. Who imported them? The public deserves to know. And let me be clear, those machines must be publicly destroyed without delay, not stored in a government warehouse where they can be quietly retrieved. Not reallocated to some favoured contractor. They must be destroyed and crushed into scrap.

Mr Speaker, now let me turn to the Gold Board. The Gold Board, according to the International Monetary Fund (IMF), incurred losses not exceeding GH¢7 billion as of the end of 2025. This Report from the IMF is something that Government should be concerned about. How can they be selling gold and incurring losses? Mr Speaker, the Minority raised this alarm upon receipt of the IMF Report, and we expect our Motion to be taken on the Floor for us to

interrogate. Mr Speaker, we are not interested in 15-month reserves of import cover. We are not interested in the so-called macroeconomic numbers, the so-called inflation. Inflation is best felt by the ordinary Ghanaian in the market. We are not interested in their paper figures for the IMF.

Mr Speaker, what the President did not tell the people of Ghana is the challenges going on in the recruitment exercise. Ghana is a nation that must embrace the future. Artificial intelligence (A.I.), digital systems, and technological innovation are not things we should fear. In fact, if we want to compete globally, we must move boldly into that future. But Mr Speaker, technology must work for the people; it must not become a barrier between the people and opportunity. Today, many young Ghanaians are deeply frustrated with this A.I. recruitment system that has been introduced. Across the country, young men and women, graduates, unemployed youth, and hopeful applicants have spent their last money purchasing recruitment vouchers, only to face systems that reject their Personal Identification Numbers (PINs), flag them incorrectly, or prevent them from completing the applications. For many of these young people, this was not just a technical inconvenience; it was a difference between hope and disappointment.

Mr Speaker, we must also remember that Ghana is still a country with real infrastructure challenges. Reliable internet is not available everywhere. Electricity is not constant everywhere. Many applicants do not have laptops or

smartphones. Some must travel long distances to find a place with internet access to attempt the applications. So, when a system is designed entirely around digital access without considering those realities, it risks excluding the very people it was meant to help. Technology should level the playing field, not tilt it. Mr Speaker, when legitimate systems fail, illegitimate actors quickly step in. Already, we are hearing worrying reports of middlemen and scammers exploiting desperate young people, promising shortcuts into recruitment processes in exchange for money. This is how systems that are meant to create transparency can unintentionally create new forms of exploitation.

But beyond all of these, there is something even more important at stake: the trust of our youth. The young people of this country want to believe that opportunities in Ghana are fair. They want to believe that if they follow the rules, if they apply through the proper channels, the system will work for them. When that faith begins to erode, frustrations grow. Mr Speaker, this is not about rejecting technology. Artificial intelligence is here to stay, and Ghana must move forward with digital transformation. But progress must be thoughtful, it must be inclusive, and it must always place the Ghanaian people at the centre. Therefore, I respectfully, on behalf of my Colleagues in the Minority, submit that there must be an immediate review of the current A.I. recruitment system to ensure that it is transparent, accessible, and fair to every Ghanaian youth, whether they live in Accra or in

the remotest communities of this country. Because, Mr Speaker, a system designed to create opportunity must never become a barrier to opportunity. Indeed, our young people deserve better, and the National Democratic Congress (NDC) Government must hear this loud and clear. The young people of Ghana deserve better.

Mr Speaker, let me proceed to also draw the Government's attention to one more thing. There is no NDC Ghana, there is no New Patriotic Party (NPP) Ghana. I call on the Government, forthwith, to reinstate all those Ghanaian youth who were dismissed as a result of the directive of the Government to state agencies. Mr Speaker, those young Ghanaians have families and have aspirations too; they should not suffer just because there is a change of government. Mr Speaker, it has been over a year. The Government must reinstate them to go back to work. It is unfair, and one day, it will come back and haunt them.

Mr Speaker, let me refer to another suffering of the ordinary Ghanaian: electricity tariffs. Mr Speaker, to go down memory lane, in the second quarter of 2015, we saw electricity hikes going as high as 31 per cent. By the fourth quarter of 2015, electricity tariffs had increased to 59 per cent. Mr Speaker, in total, under the previous NDC Administration, in 2015 alone, electricity tariffs increased by 90 per cent, while water increased by 88 per cent. Mr Speaker, today, NDC is back, and what do we see? On 3rd May, 2025, electricity tariffs increased by 14.75 per cent. On 1st

July, 2025, 2.45 per cent. On 1st October, 2025, 1.14 per cent. Mr Speaker, on 1st January, 2026, 9.8 per cent. Mr Speaker, that put together is a total of 28.14 per cent in electricity tariffs alone. Mr Speaker, that is a record of the NDC, and that is a record that the President did not talk about.

Mr Speaker, this Government has also failed in ensuring the implementation of the 24-Hour Economy.

3:04 p.m.

They promised the Ghanaian youth that there will be one job, three shifts. The President came here, he did not talk about the one job, three shifts. What we see is frustration of our people.

They also promised the women that there was going to be a Women's Development Bank. Mr Speaker, it is been over a year. When are we going to have the Women's Development Bank? That is also another matter the President refused to talk about.

Mr Speaker, on the foreign front, our compatriots who are on peacekeeping are in harm's way. Mr Speaker, on a true state of the nation, we expected the President to talk about the suffering of our soldiers in peacekeeping. We are aware of their predicaments, the bombing in the area that they are. But the President has not spoken about it; none of his Ministers had the courage to come to Parliament to address the nation on this. We the Minority Caucus, hereby say that we are with our compatriots who are in Lebanon. We share in their pain and

wish those who are injured a speedy recovery. We urge Government to take steps in ensuring that the necessary support systems are in place, the proper diplomatic channels are engaged to protect our compatriots who are on peacekeeping in Lebanon.

Then, Mr Speaker, what happened to our market women in Burkina Faso, with eight of them killed, no concrete steps were taken to help the families. Mr Speaker, again, we say to their families, we mourn with them; we stand with them and we expect Government to take steps to support their families and not to abandon them.

Mr Speaker, it has been several months after the unfortunate helicopter crash. We know that the Minister for Finance has a heavy responsibility. What we understood from the President then was that the Minister for Finance was to act for some few weeks to enable him to appoint a new Minister for Defence. Unfortunately, because security is not the priority of this Government, to date, there is no substantive Minister for Defence appointed to take affairs of state at the Ministry of Defence. This, Mr President did not talk about and we see it as a major policy failure of the Government. Mr Speaker, we urge the President to prioritise the security of Ghanaian lives and ensure that our Ministry of Defence is properly manned by a Minister with full responsibility.

Mr Speaker, what the President did not also talk about is the human rights abuses we have seen the past year. Many appointees on our Side were either

arrested without warrant or, even when they themselves had reported themselves to the investigating agency, they granted them very onerous bail conditions with an attempt to keep them, and instead of the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice using the court to prosecute cases, he decided to use press conference to persecute them. Mr Speaker, we find this very unacceptable.

Mr Speaker, the President has told us that under the 69th Independence celebration of our Republic, the theme is, “Building Prosperity, Restoring Hope”. We beg to ask the questions; what hope are we restoring when the President is failing to address issues in the private sector? What hope have we when the President is not creating jobs? What we want the Government to know is that, Mr Speaker, no matter how long it takes, they have just three years left. We, the Minority, will endure. We will stand with the people of Ghana, relying on the words of Martin Luther King,

“We cannot walk alone. And as we walk, we must make the pledge that we shall always march ahead. We cannot turn back”.

The Minority will never turn back. We will walk with the people of Ghana. We will stand firm for their interests and we know that come 2028, the tables will turn. [*Hear! Hear!*]

Mr Speaker, for those who are abusing their power and authority, let me remind them that the ravaging clouds shall not long be victorious. They shall not long possess the sky. We urge them to be

measured in the exercise of their duties even as they are in public office.

Yesterday, Mr Speaker, we experienced a sad situation in this Chamber where the Deputy Minister for Finance came here with his own piece of propaganda, which propaganda was already contained in the Message on the State of the Nation by the President. Mr Speaker, we welcome that report and we pray that they would be able to be firm when that day comes for their own accountability.

Mr Speaker, yesterday these were the words of the Majority Chief Whip. He admitted that the suffering of the Ghanaian youth has hit his Side and these were his own words. I quote:

“Mr Speaker, the pressure on MPs as we sit here, our phones are beaming with messages about disqualification and so let me assure the House and the entire nation that the Minister for the Interior, especially in respect of the services that fall under his supervision, is taking steps to address the issues.”

Mr Speaker, it is our hope that the Majority will walk the talk and ensure that the masses who are suffering get a fair opportunity to get recruited.

And Mr Speaker, before I resume my seat, let me reiterate one more time that the rice farmers need the attention of Government. The cocoa farmers need the attention of Government. The young farmers, the poor young farmers need the attention of Government. Maize farmers need the attention of Government. Mr

Speaker, the Government should not only think about its comfort.

[Members of the Minority displayed foodstuffs and sang.]

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, that said, I want to submit, finally, that the President must come again and address the nation on all the issues happening and ensure that the youth of the country who were promised jobs are given jobs; that steps are taken to build a transparent system that will help grow our economy. If they come honestly and walk with us, Mr Speaker, we would walk with them for the sake of our country. Mr Speaker, that said, I want to thank you—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Once your time is up, your time is up.

[Uproar]

[Members of the Minority displayed foodstuffs and sang]

3:14 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members of the Minority, let us not overdo things. It is now t

he turn of the Majority Leader who will also speak for 30 minutes.

Yes, Majority leader, you have the floor.

Hon Members of the Minority, we should not be compelled to do what we should not do.

Majority Leader (Mr Mahama Ayariga): Mr Speaker, before I go on to the text of my closing debate on the Message on the State of the Nation as presented by the President, let me just correct some inaccuracies in the presentation of my Colleague. He said that the President did not say anything about the plight of our soldiers in the Middle East because of the conflict. What he has forgotten is that the President delivered the Message on the State of the Nation on 27th February while America and Israel attacked Iran on the 28th February, a day after. *[Uproar]* How could the President be addressing this House on a matter that had not occurred? *[Uproar]*

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Nitiwul, with all due respect, you are a former leader.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, again, he questioned the commitment of this Government by saying that we should not keep excavators and chafangs in warehouses but rather burn them. Mr Speaker, in which civilised world would a government seize excavators, dozers, trucks and burn them? In which civilised society would a nation do that? Those equipment have alternative uses. Someone might bring it in with the intention of using it for an illegal purpose. But when the State seizes it, that equipment is available to be used for a perfectly legal purpose. So, I cannot fathom how the leader of the Minority will suggest that every excavator seized at the port, not at the mining site, should be burned at the port. But when we run out of ideas, we hear all those things.

Mr Speaker, we gather here not merely to fulfil a formal constitutional debate on the Message on the State of the Nation, but to bear witness to a national resurrection. For three long years, our Republic walked through a valley of economic shadows, a wilderness where the air was thick with the dust of devaluation and the ground was cracked by the heat of excruciating debt. We were a nation that forgot how to dream because we were too busy trying to survive. We were a people whose resilience was tested until the very marrow of our national character was laid bare.

But as the old proverb teaches us, and as the President so poignantly reminded this House, however long the night, the dawn will break. Mr Speaker, look out of this august House. That dawn is no longer a distant promise we recite in our prayers. It is a rising sun that is warming the hearts of our people from Hamile to Half Assini. The state of our nation is no longer a story of survival. It is a chronicle of revival. It is the story of a people who refused to let the fire of the Black Star go out. Let us be clear-eyed about the ruins we inherited.

On 19th December, 2022, Ghana fell. We declared a debt default, a dark cold day, when our national word was no longer our bond. We inherited a shackle of 80 billion in energy debt and an economy gasping for air with inflation at 54.1 per cent. Our reserves were depleted. Our credit was crashed. Our youth looked at the horizon and saw only a world of uncertainty and despair. But Mr Speaker, a House is not judged by

how it stands in the sun, but by how it held firm during the storm. When the winds of that default threatened to rip the roof off our Republic, there were those who whispered that Ghana was finished. They suggested we were a failed experiment but they were wrong.

Under the Resetting Ghana Agenda, we did not just patch the leaks. We reinforced the foundation. We chose the difficult part of structural integrity over the easy part of political convenience. We performed a fiscal bypass on a dying economy and today, the patient is not just walking, the patient is running and ready to fly. *[Hear! Hear!]*

In a spectacular display of fiscal athleticism, our cedi has ceased its frantic retreat. It has appreciated by 40.7 per cent against the U.S. dollar and 30.9 per cent against the pound. We settled a 709-million-euro bond ahead of schedule not because we had excess, but because we had discipline. Today, the global arbiters: Fitch, Moody's and S&P, now sing a chorus of approval with a triple credit upgrade. This is not a trophy for the Cabinet. It is a certificate of strength for every Ghanaian who kept faith when the nights were cold. Mr Speaker, my Friends on the other Side say they are just statistics. To them, I say numbers are the language of the State, but food is the language of the home.

General inflation has plummeted to 3.8 per cent. Food inflation has been tamed to 4.9 per cent. When petrol prices drop from 15.20 to 9.99, it is a pay raise for every taxi driver. Every truck driver and trader gets a cheque when the prices

of petrol reduce. We abolished the nuisance taxes: e-levy, the betting tax, the emission tax, returning GH¢6 billion to the pockets of ordinary Ghanaians. *[Hear! Hear!]* Nowhere is this revival more spectacular than in the financial sector. Once the graveyard of our hopes, there were days when the vault was empty and the future was mortgaged. Days when the collapse of our banking institutions felt like a permanent eclipse. But today, Mr Speaker, the 2025 Monetary Policy Report signals a recovery that borders on the miraculous.

3:24 p.m.

Our total assets have surged to a monumental GH¢447 billion. This is not just a figure; it is a fortress. It is a testament to a system purged on its weaknesses and fortified by integrity. We have moved from the precipice of systemic collapse to a summit of liquidity. We have ensured that the savings of Ghanaians are no longer a gamble but a guarantee. *[Hear! Hear!]* Let me repeat that. We have ensured that the savings of Ghanaians are no longer a gamble but a guarantee.

Mr Speaker, the heart of this Republic beats in our cocoa farms. So let me speak about cocoa farms. For decades, the Ghanaian farmer was a spectator to the wealth generated by his own beans. They bore the heat of the sun while others enjoyed the sweetness of the chocolate. We have shattered that glass ceiling. By institutionalising the cocoa sector reforms, we have ensured that the historic surge in global cocoa prices is delivered directly to the farm gate. We

have moved the producer price to unprecedented heights, ensuring that when the world pays more for a bar of chocolate, the farmer in Sefwi, Enchi and Tepa finally sees a reflection of that value in his pocket. That is the essence of the reforms in the sector, so that the world market price will move directly to the farmer.

Today, when the world market price is bad, the farmer will feel it. But by the system we have put in place, when tomorrow, the world market price is good, the farmer will stand in good stead. This is not mere commerce. It is the restoration of the dignity of the Ghanaian soil. We are moving from being exporters of raw toil to masters of our own industrial destiny, investing in local processing so that the term “made in Ghana” becomes a global standard of excellence, not a colonial footnote. *[Hear! Hear!]*

Mr Speaker, yet, let us speak the truth that the corridors of power often fear, the call for accountability. I hear my Colleague, the Minority Leader, speak about human rights abuses and harassment of erstwhile appointees of the New Patriotic Party (NPP). The call for accountability is not a pursuit of vengeance. It is a requirement of constitutional hygiene. When a regime exits the corridors of power, leaving behind a trail of depleted reserves, astronomical debt and unvouched for expenditures; the silence of the successor is not statesmanship, it is complicity. To ignore the financial misdeeds of the past is to tell the future that the public purse

is a trophy for the swift rather than a trust for the people.

We cannot build a reset Ghana on a foundation of impunity. We must ensure that those who treated the national treasury as a private fiefdom are brought to face the stern, impartial light of the law. Accountability acts as the ultimate deterrent against the recurrence of fiscal recklessness. If the architects of the 2022 debt default and the purveyors of inflated sole source contracts walk away into a comfortable retirement, we effectively institutionalise corruption as a low-risk, high-reward venture. By pursuing forensic audits and legal recovery, the state signals that, the value for money principle is not a rhetorical flourish but a binding legal mandate.

It is a moral necessity to show the taxpayer, who is currently enduring the hard choices of recovery, that their sacrifice is not being used to subsidise the past theft of a privileged few. Ultimately, this is about the restoration of the soul of our democracy. Financial accountability ensures that the institutional resolve to speak of it is backed by the weight of justice. We do not seek to settle scores; we seek to settle the accounts of the Republic. It is only by cleaning the stables of the previous regime can we guarantee that the new dawn we are building, is not just a change of faces but a fundamental change in the character of Ghanaian governance.

The Accra Reset is our continental manifesto. With the passage of the 24-Hour Economy Authority Bill, we have

unlocked the gates of productivity that were locked by the sunset for 60 years. Mr Speaker, let me repeat that, with the passage of the 24-Hour Economy Authority Bill, 2025, we have unlocked the gates of productivity that were locked by the sunset for 60 years. Critics ask, why a 24-Hour Economy? I tell them, it is because poverty does not take a break at 8 p.m. Hunger does not sleep. We are breaking the 8 to 5 shackles. Backed by an initial GH¢110 million, we are returning the dead of light into the bread of life.

From the Accra-Kumasi Expressway to the Volivo Bridge, Ghana is once again a construction site. *[Hear! Hear!]* We are creating jobs, expanding businesses, building roads, building arteries for commerce, with 27,000 new jobs in our garment factories. We are stitching the fabric of a new middle class. We are rebalancing the scales of justice through education. The No Fee Stress Initiative has already shielded 152,698 first-year students from financial exclusion, a number set to rise to 220,000.

In health, we launched MahamaCares with a GH¢2.9 billion fund for chronic diseases. Should a father have to choose between university fees and his wife's dialysis? Should that be the case? Today, we are tearing up that ledger of despair. We have seized our sovereignty from the hands of donors and placed it back into the hands of our doctors. We are ending the no-bed syndrome because a healthful bed is a right of citizenship, not a prize for the privileged.

Our Feed Ghana Programme is a pillar of our sovereignty. We are procuring 660 tractors and 400 combined harvesters. We are determined to slash out US\$400 million poultry import bill by raising 10 million birds on our own soil. We will not be a nation that begs for what we can grow. Let me repeat that, we will not be a nation that begs for what we can grow. Let it be known, the era of the sole sourced contract is dead. The Value for Money Office Bill is our sword against waste.

Mr Speaker, as I take my seat, let us remember that the Republic is larger than any political party. It belongs to the nurse in Ho, the teacher in Gambaga, the fisherman in Mori, the youth in the Dawa industrial zones. Nations endure not because they are spared trials, but because there are people who refuse to surrender. We were tested by the fairness of debt and like the fine gold of our soil, we have emerged purer and stronger.

Let history record that in 2026, we did not just build prosperity. We restored the soul of a nation. We chose action over apathy. We chose the light of accountability over the darkness of complicity. We chose the farmer over the financier. The dawn is no longer breaking, the morning is here. It is a morning of work, a morning of justice, a morning of hope and that morning, bright, bold and beautiful, belongs to the people of Ghana.

I thank you Mr Speaker. *[Hear! Hear!]*

3:34 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, Order! Order!

Hon Members, on Tuesday, 3rd March, 2026, the Hon Member for Bolgatanga Central and Chairman of the Committee on Finance, Hon Isaac Adongo moved this Motion and it was seconded by the Hon Member for Assin South and the Ranking Member for the Committee on Defence and Interior, Hon Rev John Ntim Fodjour. As was determined by the Leadership, the two Leaders have successfully concluded the debate today.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I shall, in accordance with Standing Order 72(4), formally convey the gratitude of the House to His Excellency, the President of the Republic of Ghana.

Yes, Majority Leader, any indication?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, as Leaders have concluded the debate on the Message on the State of the Nation, we think that it is an opportune time to adjourn for today so that tomorrow we can come back at 2 p.m. to consider that Business.

Mr Speaker, I thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, the application is to have the House adjourned. Any seconder?

Second Deputy Minority Whip (Mr Jerry Ahmed Shaib): Mr Speaker,

while I proceed to second the Motion, there is something that is persistently becoming consistent in this Chamber and there is the need for you to take a careful look at that.

Mr Speaker, the leader of the Minority stood up and visibly so. You saw him. But you ignored him. I also stood up and it was for a reason because we wanted to have a vote on this matter. You saw us but ignored us and failed to even call or pay any attention to us and you proceeded. Mr Speaker, it is a Parliament of two Sides; membership on that Side and Membership on this Side. So, if we cannot have our say, then what is happening to our Parliament?

Mr Speaker, we needed to have our say and we stood up with the purpose that you hear our Leader. Respectfully, if you had heard our Leader, it would have spoilt nothing. It would have meant that we are prosecuting democracy. It would have meant that the other part, which is the Minority, would have been heard and we cannot always be thrown under the bus while our views are ignored whenever we rise to express them.

Mr Speaker, I think that this is very important. You always need to pay attention to us when we stand up, respectfully.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, Hon Majority Leader, do you have something to say?

Mr Ayariga: On a lighter note, Mr Speaker is right not to notice the Minority Leader because he brought

food items into the Chamber against the rules of this House. He brought yam, *kokonte*, and then rice and maize.

Mr Speaker, even more serious, contrary to the law, he has gone to bring unripe cocoa pods into the Chamber, knowing very well that there is a Legislative Instrument (L.I.) that makes it an offence to pluck cocoa that is unripe. The former Minister for Lands and Natural Resources is here; he knows that you cannot pluck unripe cocoa and then bring it to this Chamber. All the cocoa that you have displayed today are unripe cocoa that you plucked in clear violation of the law. See the green part of it; it is a clear indication that it is unripe cocoa.

Mr Speaker, I think that we have got to the end of the day. I do not think Mr Speaker intended to disregard the Minority, because we had just spoken and we are to adjourn, so I thought that there was really no issue here. But if the Minority took offence, I am sure going forward, we would address those issues.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, I take note of the submission of my very good Friend, Jerry Ahmed Shaib with great concern. I have given the 30 minutes opportunity to the Minority Leader to speak. I have also given 30 minutes opportunity to the Majority Leader to speak. Hon Members, at the conclusion of the debate, when the Speaker is speaking, you do not interrupt by the rules. You do not interrupt according to the rules. The rules are very clear that when the Speaker is speaking at the conclusion of

the debate, you do not interrupt. If you want to raise an issue regarding the Question, you wait for the Speaker to raise it. When the Question is put and the response is given, and the Speaker says the ayes have it, that is the point you get up to challenge the votes. But you do not get up when the Speaker is on the Floor speaking. The Standing Orders are very clear.

It is the same thing that you are doing. It does not make any difference. It is the same thing. So why do we always want to create the impression that any time I am presiding, I am being unfair to you? The rules are to guide us. Hon Jerry Ahmed Shaib, kindly resume your seat.

There is a Motion on the Floor for adjournment. Any seconder of the Motion?

Mr Shaib: I seconded the Motion. I only proceeded, respectfully, to make a point—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Once the Motion has been seconded — [*Uproar*]

Mr Shaib: Mr Speaker, while I was making that point, I want you to understand that the Minority Leader stood up at the time he was supposed to have. It was timeous. The Minority Leader stood up at the time he was supposed to have stood up. The moment you asked, that was when the Minority Leader stood up. It is not out of disrespect. It is not out of disrespect to you. He acted within the rules and not without reference to the rules nor with any disrespect to you and that is key.

Mr Speaker, I respect you. I just want you to understand that the Minority Leader stood up at the time he was supposed to have done so. He did that timeously. He did exactly just as you prescribed.

3:44 p.m.

I need to place that on record, Mr Speaker. Thank you very much.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, I may be blind tomorrow, but today, I am not blind.

ADJOURNMENT

The House was accordingly adjourned at 3:44 p.m. till Thursday, 12th March, 2026, at 12 noon.

